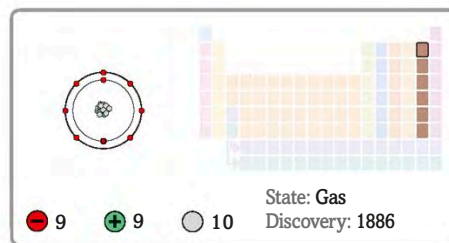


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Fluorine



Forms

Laboratory sample



Cryolite

This soft mineral is brittle, which means it breaks easily into lots of pieces.



Topaz means “fire” in the ancient Indian language of Sanskrit.

This sealed case contains a mixture of fluorine and helium.



These cubic crystals are green due to impurities.

Fluorite

Topaz



This precious gemstone contains 20.7% fluorine.

This highly reactive element is incredibly dangerous when pure: just a tiny amount added to the air can kill a person. A pale yellow gas, fluorine reacts with brick, glass, and steel, burning a hole straight through them. Because it is so dangerous, pure fluorine

is often stored in nickel containers that can resist its attack. Minerals such as **cryolite** and **fluorite** contain this element. This gas and its less harmful compounds have a wide variety of uses. Hydrofluoric acid is a toxic liquid used to etch patterns on glass, as seen in some **glass vases**.